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AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

CREATING LASTING CHANGE

Issue 37

Newsletter
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Charity no
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Our Vision: A healthy, educated, self-sufficient community in Malawi

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Our Charity Needs Your Help!

We're facing a challenge. Two of our essential vehicles used for our programmes in Malawi are no longer available, causing delays in our work. If you know of a reliable, used Toyota 4x4 that could be shipped to Malawi, please get in touch! Being a grassroots charity, we rely heavily on these vehicles to reach those in need. Ideally, we'd love to find two, but even one would make a huge difference.

On a brighter note, we have 11 amazing scholarship students who have excelled in their secondary education and secured university places starting this September! To support them with fees, equipment, transportation, and living expenses, we need £85 per month each. Every contribution, big or small, can change their future forever. Would you consider sponsoring a student? Even a general donation to our scholarship fund would be immensely helpful.

We're also excited about a new initiative at Sam's Village! We recently held a workshop teaching income-generating skills like weaving mats and placemats from recycled fabrics. To empower more women, we'd love to sponsor a loom for the next participant. A £40 donation with the reference "loom" will make this possible.

EXCITING NEWS: CONSTRUCTION BEGINS ON NEW SEND & SMU UNITS — HEALTH

We're thrilled to announce the official start of our new Special Educational Needs & Disability Unit (SEND Unit) and Safe Motherhood Unit (SMU). While we faced some delays, the project is finally underway. Let's Build It is our contractor, and architect Rumbani Chihana serves as our consultant.

The programme kicked off in May with a productive meeting involving the M'bang'ombe Clinic staff, our partners Sandi Thandiza, and the Senior Group Village Headman. This was followed by a series of community meetings with the contractor and consultant. These meetings aimed to raise awareness about the project within the community and identify potential local labourers.

We anticipate completion of the build by September, with an official opening ceremony in October. Phase One of the project will focus on:

- Early identification of babies with neurological and physical needs.
- Prompt implementation of necessary therapies.
- Long-term follow-up care to improve children's future independence.
- SEND assessments and appropriate therapies and referrals for all ages.

In addition, the Safe Motherhood Unit will offer nutritional training. Through our partners SCOPE Malawi, we'll also be implementing a permaculture garden on the premises.









Life-Saving Medical Outreach

Our ongoing Medical Outreach program continues to make a significant impact. Since January, a staggering 17,437 people in remote villages have received vital medical care. We extend our heartfelt gratitude to Love Support Unite for their unwavering support of this critical programme.

SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE

Our partners SCOPE Malawi are leading an exciting project in Chitsime with a new agro-ecology demonstration plot (top-right). This plot features fruit trees, casava, maize, medicinal plants, and even a fish pond!



In Msampha Village, 11 women were trained in creating household permaculture gardens including medicinal plants and fruit trees. This programme has blossomed, with women sharing skills and seeds, resulting in an impressive 22 gardens providing year-round food security for their families.



Love Support Unite funds our Sustainable Family Farms programme, supporting ultra-poor families caring for orphans, elderly, and disabled individuals. One beneficiary, Blessings who has cerebral palsy, receives vital support alongside his blind mother and brother.

We're proud to report successful reforestation efforts. An impressive 90% of the 8,000 trees planted in February are thriving! Combined with fruit trees planted through our household permaculture and agroforestry programs, we're well on our way to reaching our goal of planting 10,000 trees per year. Consider offsetting your travels by donating to plant trees in Malawi and contribute to a greener future!









STAFF & VOLUNTEERS

Oscar Chunda—our new Operations Manager joined us in April. (top right)



Constance Kainga—our new Administrative Officer joined us in May. (middle right)

Anatazio Mwale— our new guard at Njewa office joined us in June. He replaced Clement Mkwanda who has gone to study in South Africa.

Joe Msiska, Finance Manager, resigned in March to start his own business. We wish him well. (bottom right)



Grey Msiska didn't successfully pass his probation period as Sam's Village Manager and we are now advertising for an Operations Manager at SV. Interviews will take place in July.

We had a group of 11 cyclists who did the AVM 500km challenge in Malawi in May. This was very successful and 5 stayed on to volunteer. **Jason Pennington** did a fantastic job sorting out our plumbing! (bottom left) **Cathy Withycombe** and **Gill Cochrane** did some workshops with 18 local women on making loom mats from local fabric strips and finger knitted place mats and pots (bottom right), **Stuart Withycombe** assessed a river to build a bridge and also painted a sign and **Steve Cochrane** painted the pre-school and the sign (bottom centre). Our grateful thanks to all of the cyclists for their time, commitment, energy and raising £15,342 + Gift Aid. We thank the ones that stayed on for their help and we are now looking for sponsors of looms @ £40 for the next women to be trained, so they can earn a living.









EDUCATION

Early Childhood Development (ECD) - Our pre-schools are flourishing, with a daily average of 730 children in attendance. Thanks to a generous benefactor, all 12 ECD centers were able to maintain their feeding programs throughout 2023/24. Funsani is partnered with **Gandys International** and they have provided funds to keep this feeding programme going throughout 2023/4. It was exciting to have **Keanua Porter** and **Jenny Wall** join us from Gandys on the cycle ride and visiting Funsani. They had educational gifts to give and also new t-shirts for each child (below central 3 photos). We are very grateful for all the support they provide to the children at Funsani.







School Partnerships -

We have two new partnership schools. **Flakefleet Primary School** (whose pupils famously got into the final of Britian's Got Talent in 2019) are partnered with **M'khunku Primary School** (top right). **Hillcross Primary School** (right) are now linked with **M'lumbwira Primary School** and the partnership link visit in Malawi was a joy, with children doing local dances, singing and showing their appreciation of a new partnership with the UK to learn from each other.



Adult Literacy programme graduated 46 beneficiaries in February who can now read and write, making an enormous difference to being able to run a business and sustain a livelihood.



Scholarship programme— Our scholarship students all get supported with basic needs, fees, accommodation and transport. Here are some of our students receiving some basic toiletries (centre right). We currently have 11 students needing support at University which costs £85 per month. Please can you support one of them or donate to the 'scholarship pot'? This is life-changing for them. Mphatso Tembo graduated this year (far right)







SAM'S VILLAGE



We are pleased to announce that we have been successful in getting a £30,000 grant from the **Bloom Foundation** for further vocational and life skills training.

Cathy Withycombe and Gill Cochrane ran some loom weaving and finger knitting workshops for 18 women so they can learn a skill and make an income. This was very successful and the ladies are keen to produce more items to be sold. (top right and left)



We have updated our solar and we now have more power! The Tree Block is being used and the social lounge ready (right). We made an outdoor cooking area for people who want to self-cater which is in finishing stages (left).



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THANKS TO:
LOVE SUPPORT UNITE
THE LONDON ORTHOTIC CONSULTANCY
OUR MALAWI TEAM
500 MILES
ALL SAINTS KNITTERS
TRUSTEES
GANDYS INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION
ST MATTHEW'S CHURCH
CAROL WEBB
SIAN PRITCHARD
PARTNERSHIP SCHOOLS
HEATHER CUMMINS
TONY & LIZ WILLIAMS
THE FOUNDRY INTERNATIONAL
BLOOM FOUNDATION

500km Malawi cycle challenge - pictures say it all! Wonderful trip!









98 vulnerable people received a relief package of food from AVM in February which is one of the 'hungry months'.

FUNDRAISING EVENTS

Events coming up:

Indulgence Day—June 29th 2024 in Surbiton. Therapies, stalls, bar, lunches, yoga, gong bath, raffle, piano recitals, face painting and chilled time available. Free entry from 10am—6pm.

Retreat to the Farm—10% of the profit comes to AVM. One retreat is fully booked but spaces on the Mindful stargazing & yoga retreat in August 2024. https://www.retreattothefarm.co.uk/

Ladies night—(8th, 9th or 15th) November 2024 Details to follow. Please message heather.palmer@africanvision.org.uk if you are interested. Only women I'm afraid!

Quiz Night—(14th or 15th) February 2025 Details to follow. Please message heather.palmer@africanvision.org.uk if you are interested.

AVM 20th Anniversary 2025 Either 25th or 26th April 2025. We shall be arranging a Scavenger hunt with some surprises which may involve music, pubs and quiz! Details to follow!

500km cycle challenge 2025—Will be held in June and dates to be confirmed.

Auction of promises 2025—Nov 2025. Details to follow!

Past events:



Music for Malawi evening We held this music event at The cornerHOUSE Community Arts Centre, on March 16th and raised £1,018. Our thanks to the artists who played for free, Gambling Hearts, Jennifer Kamakazi and Aden and Jacob Palmer who helped organise the event.

Pedal Power 2024 We had a really successful trip with 11 cyclists plus Sam Palmer who was the cycle leader, cycling 500km in Malawi. We were supported by Land & Lakes in Malawi. We raised £15,342 + Gift Aid for our programmes. We shall be holding another cycle challenge in June 2025 if you want to join, please let us know. Numbers limited!